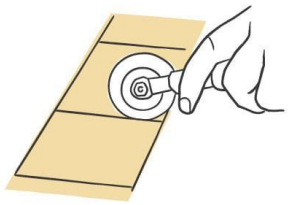
TORTELLINI

REGION	REST
Emilia-Romagna, primarily Modena and Bologna	**45 minutes to 1 hour uncovered in the refrigerator**

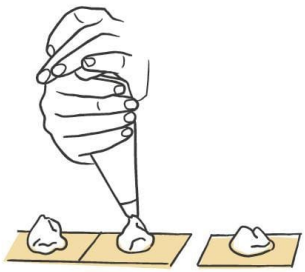
METHOD

1. Make your chosen egg-based dough, then roll and sheet it.
2. Dust a wooden board with 00 flour. Cover a sheet pan with parchment, then dust the parchment with semolina.
3. Lay one sheet on the board. Cut it into 1 3/4-inch squares with a straight-edged dough divider. A plain pastry cutter with a ruler, or a knife with a ruler, works too. Keep the squares under plastic wrap or a towel.
4. Load the filling into a pastry bag cut to a 1/4-inch opening. Pipe a hazelnut-sized circle of filling into the center of each square. With a dense filling such as meat, pinch off each portion and place it by hand instead.
5. If the dough feels dry rather than moderately tacky, mist the squares with a spray bottle held 8 to 10 inches above the board. Skip this if the dough is already tacky.
6. Hold a square in your palm and fold one corner over to the opposite corner, lining up the edges, to make a triangle.
7. Pinch the edge shut around the filling with thumb and index finger. Work back and forth a few times and push all the air out.
8. Take the bottom tips of the triangle between thumb and index finger. Wrap one side around your other index finger until the two tips meet beneath the filling in a ring. Pinch that joint tight, then flatten it to roughly the thickness of the rest of the piece so it cooks evenly.
9. Set the piece on the prepared pan. Fill and fold the rest of the squares, keeping them in a single layer, and dust the pan again with semolina.
10. Repeat with the remaining sheets.
11. Refrigerate uncovered for 45 minutes to 1 hour to dry. Covered pieces sweat and get too wet. To hold longer, lay plastic wrap loosely over the pan and refrigerate up to 8 hours.

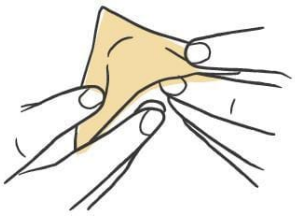
SHAPING



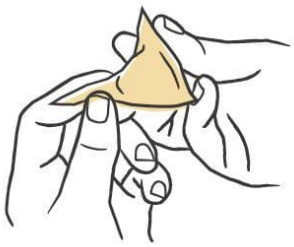
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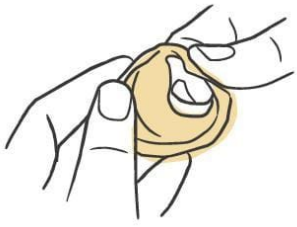
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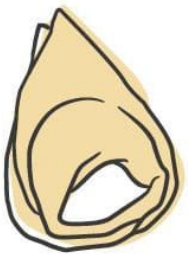
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7

NOTES

Sheet is cut into 1 3/4-inch squares with a straight-edged dough divider, the smallest square in this group, with plain edges.
Filling per piece: a hazelnut-sized amount piped through a 1/4-inch opening, or pinched off and placed by hand if the filling is dense.
Seal geometry: fold corner to corner into a triangle, pinch the edge closed, then wrap the two bottom tips around your index finger so they meet at the underside of the filling and form a ring. The ring closes tight against the filling, with no gap, which is what separates it from balanzoni.
No dimple step. The shape goes straight from the pinched edge to the ring.
The finished joint gets flattened to the thickness of the rest of the piece for even cooking.
Air must be forced out of the edge as you pinch.
Storage: 45 minutes to 1 hour uncovered to dry, then up to 8 hours refrigerated under loose plastic.
Served in brodo, unadorned. Filling is nearly always cured meat plus ground pork, veal, or chicken, with parmigiano and nutmeg.

DOUGH

Egg Dough

Makes: 954 g / Active Time: 8-10 min kneading / Rest: 30 min minimum, wrapped

INGREDIENTS

500 g	Tipo 00 flour
454 g	Egg yolks
as needed	Extra 00 flour for kneading
up to 1 tbsp, only if dry	Room-temperature water

METHOD

1. Mix the yolks lightly, without beating them.
2. Mound the flour on a wooden surface and open a well 5 to 6 inches across. Wider than that and the walls collapse.
3. Add half the yolks, drawing in flour from the inner wall with a fork, working round the circumference.
4. Add the rest the same way. If the wall breaks, scrape the escape back into the flour until the mass holds itself.
5. Knead 8 to 10 minutes: press down and away with the heel of your hand, rotate 180 degrees, fold, repeat. Scrape your hands and the board as you go.
6. Add water a tablespoon at a time only if it stays dry and refuses to come together.
7. Stop when it is smooth, firm, and springs back slightly when poked. The texture to aim for is Play-Doh.
8. Wrap and rest at least 30 minutes before rolling.

NOTES

454 g of yolks is roughly 24 to 26 eggs, so plan what the whites are for.
Yolks only, no whites and no whole eggs, which is what makes this rich and tender rather than elastic.
Dry winter air is the usual reason it will not come together. Flour the board sparingly, since excess dries it out.
Keeps 24 hours. Chilled overnight, pull it out 20 minutes before rolling.

DATE ____ / ____ / ____ RATING ____ / 5 OVEN ADJ _____

NOTES _____

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